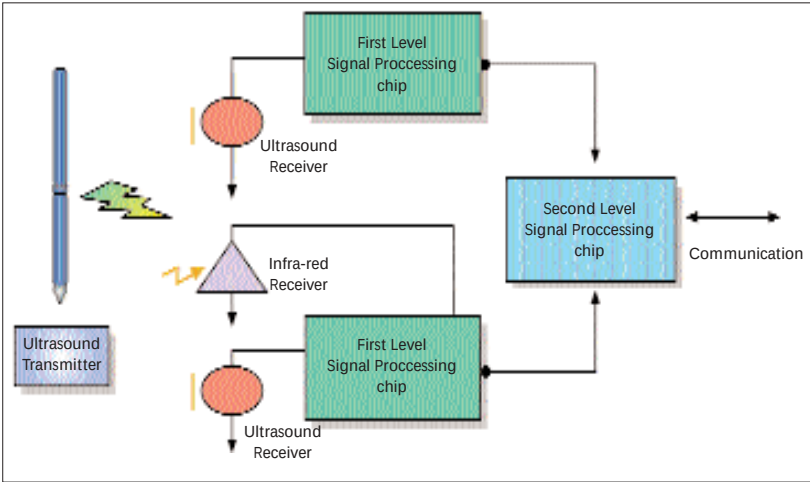
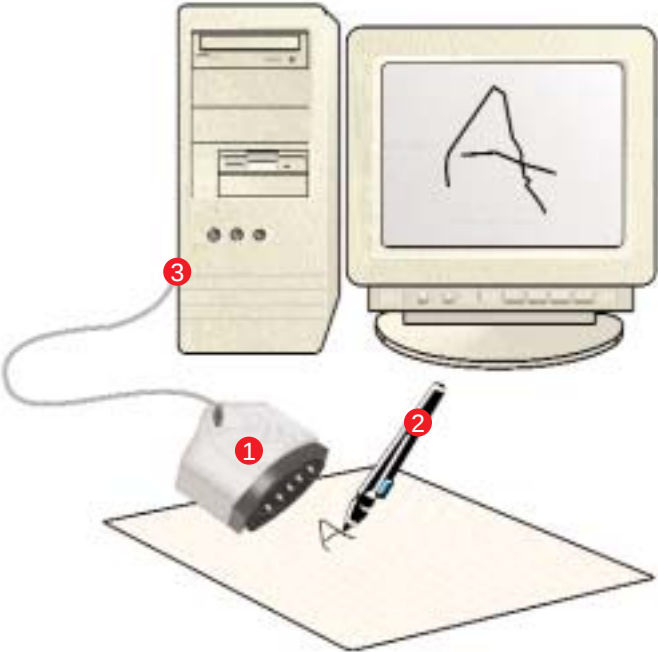




Buying Tips

✓ **TECHNOLOGY:** Owing to its sensitivity to pressure, devices based on the older Electro Magnetic Technology (EMR) are mainly favoured by graphic artists. The main drawback of the latest electro-optical input devices is that they require special pen and paper. Ultrasonic technology is the most viable of the three, as it adapts easily to every market segment and application using regular ink and paper.

✓ **TYPES OF DEVICE:** Get to know the solution fully before you purchase it. Make sure it supports the operating system you intend using it with. Opting for a costlier feature-packed pen translates to a beneficial investment for the future. These solutions also come in package deals that bundle along a pen, tablet and a mouse as well. Other devices come with their own writing pads.

✓ **CONNECTIVITY:** Choose a device that can connect easily to your PC, and can be used with your PDA and laptop as well. Make sure that there are no issues with the drivers, so that you have a hassle-free user experience.

① **The receiver:** Input from a stylus or pen goes from the receiver to be displayed on the monitor.

② **The pen or the stylus:** This is the means of input used to send signals to the internals of the device.

③ **Connector:** It's normally attached to the receiver and comes with various connectivity options. The most commonly used connector is USB.

Do Remember

- The stylus or pen is similar in size to a regular pen. You can enter text in your natural handwriting—something that makes it very convenient to use.
- Do not fall for marketing gimmicks. Opt for a solution that suits your usage style and budget.
- Understand all technological aspects involved with the solution before making a buying decision. Keep away from the 'spend now, understand later' trap.
- See to it that the manufacture packs in a few extra styli in the tablet solution. They are easily misplaced.
- Check if the bundled software is compatible with other applications. Regular updates and patches show that the company is serious in providing support to its customers.

The Future

Owing to their ease of use, natural input devices are being used extensively world-wide. Designing and digital signatures are applications favoured by professionals world-wide. College students find such devices an easy, simple tool to take down notes and complete assignments sooner. With newer and more user friendly solutions coming out, the only way this market can go is up.

Quick Find	
YOU NEED	A substitute for a mouse
Basic Use	
LOOK FOR	A very basic solution sans all fancy frills and features
YOU NEED	A natural input device that will be used occasionally
Inter Use	
LOOK FOR	A solution that has value-adds, such as a mouse and tablet bundled along
YOU NEED	An device that is to be used extensively for work that cannot be done using a mouse
Prof Use	
LOOK FOR	A feature-packed solution with a wide variety of connectivity options